

Apache OpenOffice

Version 4.1

Impress Guide

AOO Documentation Team

Chapter **4**

Adding and Formatting Pictures

Copyright

This document is Copyright © 2025 by The Apache Software Foundation. You may distribute it and/or modify it under the terms of the Creative Commons Attribution License, version 3.0 or later (<https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/3.0/>).

Apache, Apache OpenOffice, and OpenOffice.org are trademarks of the Apache Software Foundation. Used with permission.

Acknowledgments

This book is updated from a previous version by the OOoAuthors team. The AOO Documentation Team appreciates the many contributions of Michael Scarborough and Michele Petrovsky.

Publication date and software version

Published October 30, 2025. Based on Apache OpenOffice 4.1.

Note for Mac Users

Some keystrokes and menu items differ on a Mac from those used in Windows and Linux. The table below gives some common substitutions for the instructions in this chapter. For a more detailed list, see the application Help.

Windows/Linux	Mac equivalent	Effect
Tools > Options menu selection	OpenOffice > Preferences	Access setup options
<i>Right-click</i>	<i>Control+click</i>	Open context menu
<i>Ctrl</i> (Control)	⌘ (Command)	Used with other keys
<i>F5</i>	<i>Shift+⌘+F5</i>	Open the Navigator
<i>F11</i>	<i>⌘+T</i>	Open Styles & Formatting window

Contents

Chapter 4

Adding and Formatting Pictures.....	1
Introduction.....	4
Inserting Pictures.....	4
Inserting a Picture from a File.....	4
Inserting a Picture from a Scanner.....	5
Inserting a Picture from the Gallery.....	6
Managing the Gallery Themes.....	7
Adding Images to the Gallery.....	7
Deleting Images from the Gallery.....	8
Adding a New Theme to the Gallery.....	8
Formatting Pictures.....	9
Moving a Picture.....	9
Resizing a Picture.....	9
Rotating a Picture.....	10
Formatting using the Picture Toolbar.....	11
Deleting a Picture.....	14
Creating an Image Map.....	14

Introduction

Why are pictures so often used in presentations? They can convey a large amount of information more quickly than the written word. They can also give the presentation a professional look by adding logos and hallmarks. You can use Impress to create a presentation consisting only of pictures, such as a slideshow of holiday snapshots to share with friends.

This chapter describes how to insert and format pictures.

Inserting Pictures

This section describes several ways to insert a picture from an external source into an Impress presentation. Once the picture has been inserted, it can be formatted as explained later in this chapter.

Inserting a Picture from a File

Inserting a picture from a file is quick and easy. First, choose the slide layout, as described in Chapter 1 (Introducing Impress). Most layouts include a set of icons for inserting objects, but you can insert a picture into any slide.

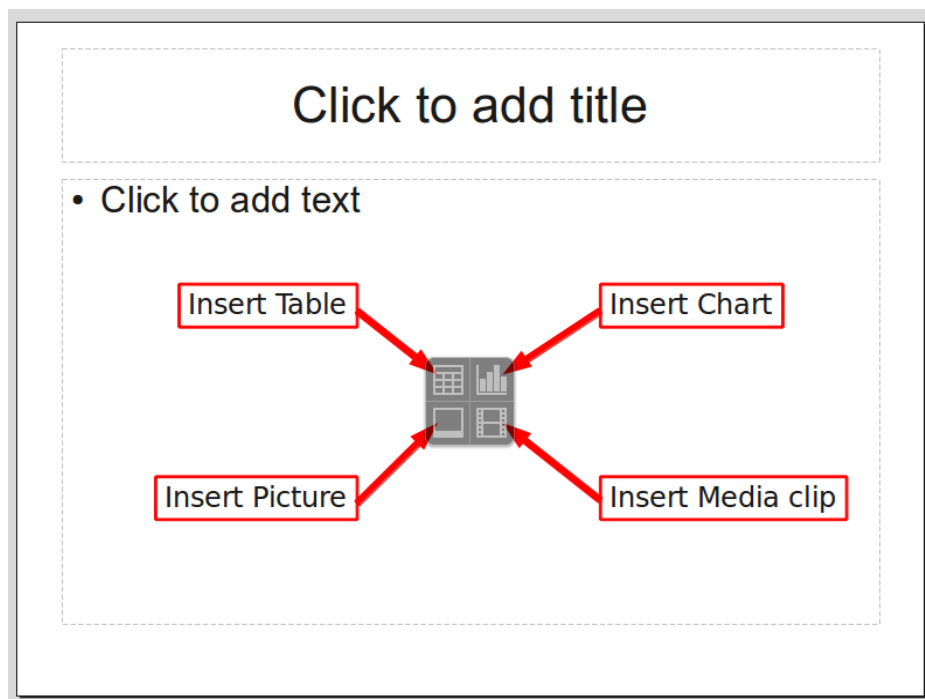


Figure 1: Slide with a placeholder for inserting objects

Whether you are using an AutoLayout for the placement of the picture or you are just inserting a picture, follow these steps:

- 1) Click on the **Insert Picture** icon or choose **Insert > Picture > From file** from the menu bar.
- 2) In the Insert picture dialog, navigate to the directory containing the desired picture.
- 3) Select the file. AOO recognizes a large number of image types. If the **Preview** option (in the lower left-hand area) is selected, a thumbnail of the selected file will be displayed in the preview pane on the right (not shown below).

- 4) Click **Open** to place the picture on the current (selected) slide. The picture is now displayed on the slide with green resizing handles around it.

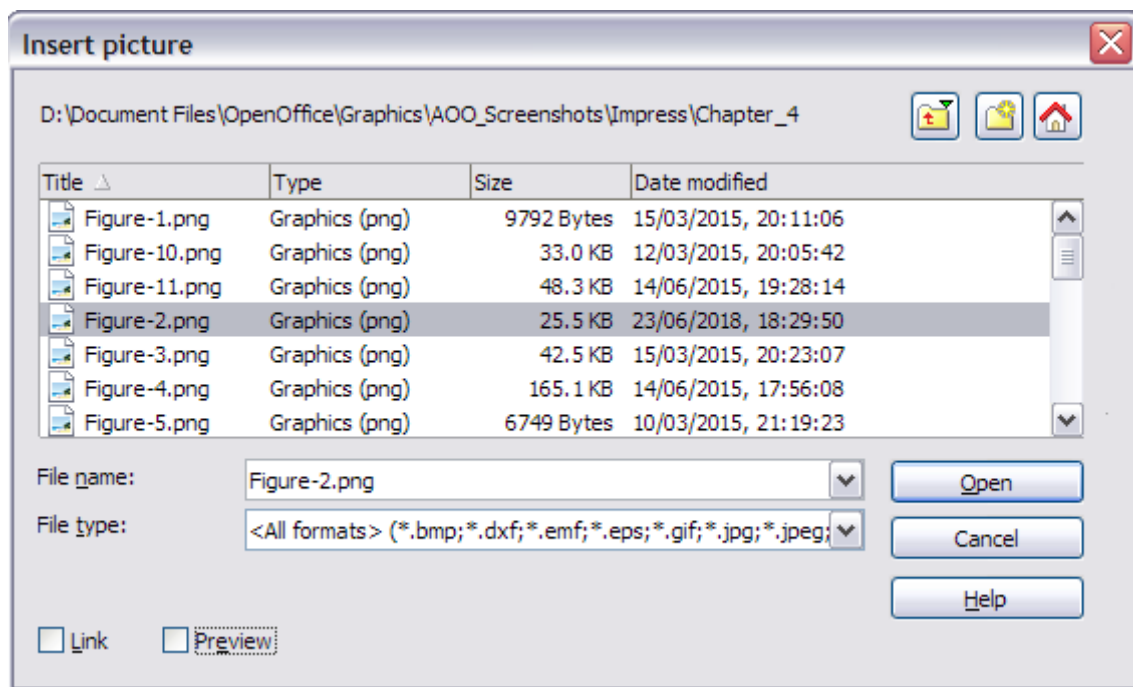


Figure 2: Inserting a picture from a file

Notice the two options, **Link** and **Preview**, in the lower left of the Insert picture dialog. Their position is determined by the underlying operating system, but most frequently, they are located at the bottom left.

Select the **Link** option to insert the picture as a link to the file rather than embedding it in the file itself. In general, it is preferable to embed images so that the presentation can be copied to other computers. However, on some occasions, it makes sense to link the image rather than embed it. These include:

- When the image file is quite large, linking rather than embedding will dramatically reduce the size of the presentation file
- When the same image file is used in many presentations (for example, when using the same background image for all the presentations created)
- When the linked file will be available when loading the presentation (for example, if the presentation is a slide show of holiday pictures)

Inserting a Picture from a Scanner

Inserting an image from a scanner is usually straightforward. Make sure the scanner is supported by the SANE system if you are running Linux or any other UNIX-like system, or TWAIN if you are using a Windows version. Also, make sure the scanner is already configured on the machine where AOO is running. In case more than one scanner or equivalent device is present, select the source from **Insert > Picture > Scan > Select Source**.

To insert an image from the scanner:

- 1) Prepare the image in the scanner and make sure that the scanner is ready.
- 2) Choose **Insert > Picture > Scan > Request**.

- 3) The rest of the procedure depends on the scanner driver and interface. You will normally be required to specify the resolution, a scan window, and other parameters. Consult the scanner's documentation for more information.
- 4) When the image is ready, Impress places it in the slide. At this point, it can be edited as would any other image.

Inserting a Picture from the Gallery

The Gallery contains a collection of images that you can use in a presentation. You can also add your own images to the Gallery, making it an essential tool for creating presentations quickly and with a consistent look. The Gallery is available in all components of OpenOffice. For an introduction to the Gallery, see Chapter 10 (Graphics, the Gallery, and Fontwork) in the *Getting Started* guide.

Choose **Tools > Gallery** or click the Gallery icon  on the Drawing toolbar or select the Gallery deck in the Sidebar (Figure 3).

The Gallery displays named themes with images stored under each category. Select a theme from the theme pane and then scroll through the images to find a suitable one. Click on the image and drag it onto the workspace. Figure 3 shows an example of the Sidebar Gallery deck.

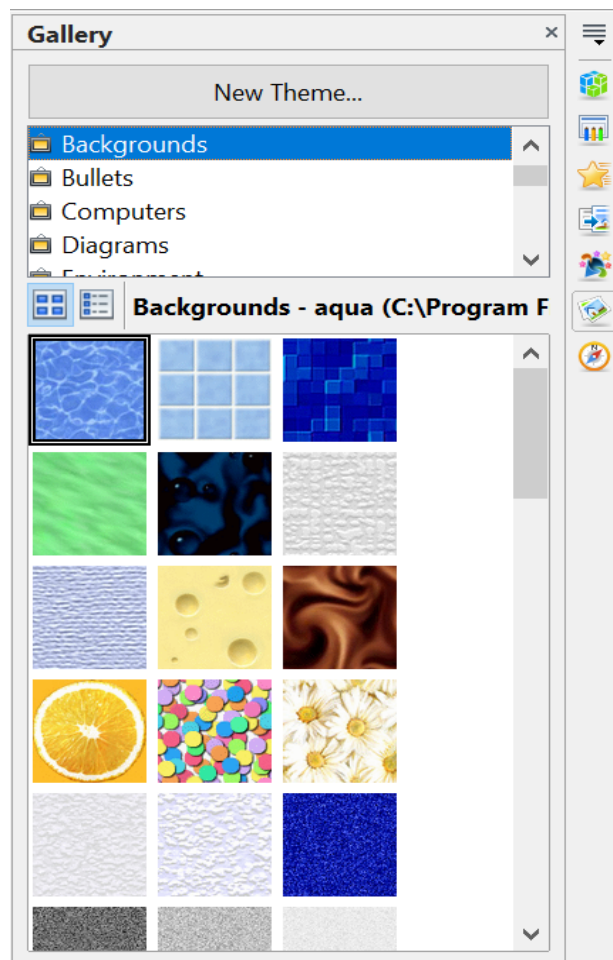


Figure 3. The Gallery Deck of the Sidebar

At this point, the image will be in your slide, but its size may not be satisfactory. If necessary, resize it as described in “Resizing a Picture” on page 9.

Positioning the Gallery

If you access the Gallery with **Tools > Gallery** or with the icon on the Drawing toolbar, it appears above the workspace. This shrinks the workspace, and you may want to optimize the size of the Gallery, undock it to place it in a more convenient position, or hide it. On modern wide screens, it is usually more convenient to use the Gallery in the Sidebar

To expand the Gallery when it's above the workspace, position the pointer over the line that divides it from the top of the workspace. When the pointer changes to parallel lines with arrows, click and drag downward. The workspace will resize in response.

By default, the Gallery is docked above the Impress workspace. To undock it, hold down the *Control* key and double-click on the upper part of the Gallery next to the View icons. To dock it again, double-click in the same area.

When the Gallery is docked, to hide it and view the full Impress workspace, click the **Hide/Show** button in the middle of the thin bar separating the Gallery from the workspace (see Figure 4). The **Hide/Show** button lets you keep the Gallery open for quick access while you create your slide show, yet out of the way when you need it to be.

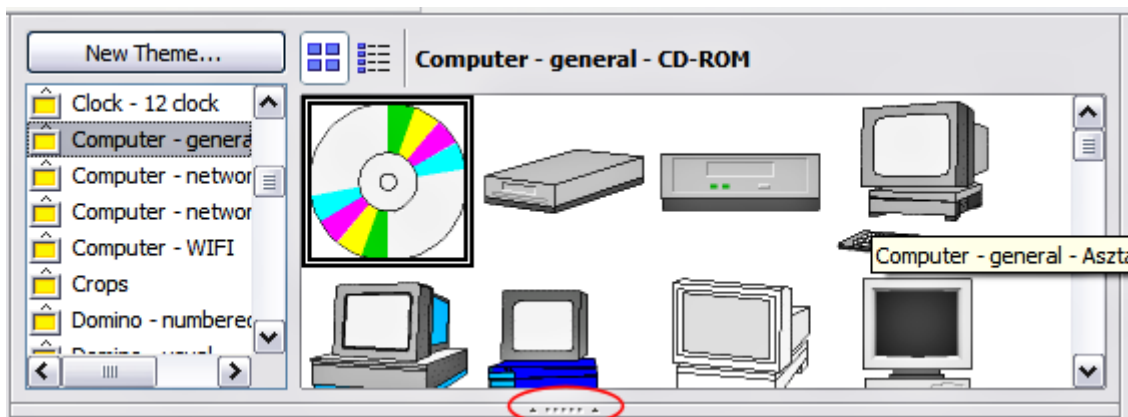


Figure 4: The Gallery with the Hide/Show selector circled

Managing the Gallery Themes

Graphics in the Gallery are grouped by themes, such as Bullets, Rulers, and Text shapes. The box above or on the left of the gallery window lists the available themes. Click on a theme to see its graphics displayed in the Gallery window.

The default themes are locked; no items can be added or deleted from these themes. The locked themes are easily recognizable by right-clicking on them; the only available option in the pop-up menu is **Properties**.

In a default installation, only the *My Theme* theme is customizable. You can add your own graphics to this gallery or add new themes as explained on page 8.

Adding Images to the Gallery

You can add new images to themes that you created, or to *My Theme* :

- 1) Right-click on the theme name in the list of themes and choose **Properties** from the pop-up menu.
- 2) Click the **Files** tab, if necessary.

- 3) Click **Add**.
- 4) Select a file; click Open. The image is added to the theme.

Deleting Images from the Gallery

To delete an image from a theme:

- 1) Right-click on the image in the Gallery window.
- 2) Choose **Delete** from the pop-up menu. A message appears, asking if you want to delete this object.
- 3) Click **Yes**.

Note

The image is deleted from the Gallery only. The original image file is not deleted.

All the images in a gallery are actually linked files. From time to time, it is beneficial to update the gallery theme to ensure that all the files are still there. To do so, right-click on the theme where you added at least one file and then select **Update** from the pop-up menu.

Adding a New Theme to the Gallery

- 1) Click the **New Theme** button above the list of themes.
- 2) Click the General tab and type a name for the new theme.
- 3) Click the **Files** tab (Figure 5).
- 4) Click **Find Files**. The Select Path dialog opens. Navigate to the folder that contains the image files for the new theme and click **Select**.
- 5) Back on the Files tab, either click on **Add All** to install all of the files in the selected folder, or use *File Type* and/or select one or more files from the displayed list, and click on **Add** to install a selection of files to the new theme.
- 6) Click **OK** when finished.
- 7) The new theme will now be displayed on the list of themes in the Gallery.



Figure 5. Setting up a new theme in the Gallery

Formatting Pictures

This section discusses formatting pictures inserted with one of the methods explained in “Inserting Pictures” on page 4.

Moving a Picture

- 1) Click the picture, if necessary, to show the green resizing handles.
- 2) Move the pointer over the picture until the pointer changes shape. On most operating systems, the cursor associated with moving objects is a four-headed arrow, but it may also be a hand or other similar symbol.
- 3) Click and drag the picture to the desired position.
- 4) Release the mouse button.

For a more accurate placement of the picture, use the Position and Size dialog described in Chapter 6 (Formatting Graphic Objects).

Resizing a Picture

- 1) Click the picture in order to see its green resizing handles.
- 2) Position the pointer over one of these handles. The pointer changes shape, giving a graphical representation of the direction of the resizing.
- 3) Click and drag to resize the picture.
- 4) Release the mouse button when satisfied with the image's new size.

The corner handles resize both the width and the height of the graphic object simultaneously, while the other four handles only resize one dimension at a time.

Tip

To retain the original proportions of the graphic, *Shift+click* one of the corner handles, then drag. Be sure to release the mouse button **before** releasing the *Shift* key.

For more accurate resizing of the graphic object, use the Position and Size dialog described in Chapter 6 (Formatting Graphic Objects).

Caution



Be aware that re-sizing a bit-mapped (raster) image will adversely affect the resolution, causing some degree of blurring. Some image formats, such as .bmp (Microsoft bit map), create files which, when compressed, actually enlarge the physical size of the file. It is better to use a specialized graphics manipulation program to correctly scale the picture to the desired size before inserting it into your presentation.

Be aware of the following regarding the structure, file formats, and file name extensions for raster images.

- **.JPEG** or .JPG (Joint Photographic Experts Group): Excellent for photographs, often using lossy compression to balance quality and file size.
- **.PNG** (Portable Network Graphics): Good for web graphics, supporting lossless compression, which is ideal for images with sharp lines and transparency.
- **.GIF** (Graphics Interchange Format): Suitable for simple web graphics and animations, though less common now than PNG for static images.)
- **.TIFF** (or .TIF (Tagged Image File Format): A versatile format that can handle

both lossy and lossless compression and is frequently used in GIS and professional photography.)

- **.BMP** (Bitmap): A simple, uncompressed raster format often used for basic images.

Rotating a Picture

As with the position of the image on the page, rotation of a picture can be done manually or using a dedicated dialog. The Rotation dialog is described in Chapter 6 (Formatting Graphic Objects). To rotate a picture manually, do as follows:

- 1) Select the picture if necessary so that the green handles around it show.

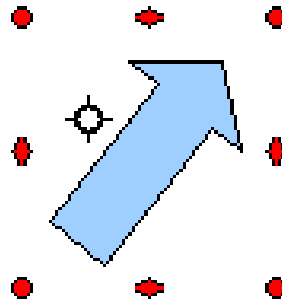


Figure 6: Shape showing the red rotating handles

- 2) Click the **Rotate** button  on the Drawing toolbar. This toolbar is usually located at the bottom of the screen, but it can be undocked and used as a floating toolbar. If the toolbar is not showing, select **View > Toolbars > Drawing**. The Drawing toolbar is discussed in detail in Chapter 5 (Creating Graphic Objects).

At this stage, a black crosshair with a circle appears in the center of the picture, representing the pivot point for the rotation. Normally, the center of the picture will be just fine, but on some occasions, you may wish to rotate around a corner or even around a point outside the picture. To do this, click on the crosshair and drag it to the desired position before applying the rotation, as shown in Figure 6.

Note

Icons representing functions in toolbars are different, depending on the operating system used. When in doubt, hover the mouse over the icons and wait for the tooltip to appear, showing the name of the button.

- 3) Eight red circular handles replace the green square handles, as shown in Figure 6. Move the mouse over one of the corner handles, and the mouse cursor shape will change. Click the mouse and move in the direction you want to rotate the picture.
- 4) When satisfied, release the mouse button.

To restrict rotation angles to multiples of 15 degrees, press the *Shift* key while rotating the graphic. This is a very handy way to rotate pictures of right angles, for example, from portrait to landscape or vice versa.

Formatting using the Picture Toolbar

When a picture is selected, the Picture toolbar shown in Figure 7 becomes available. This toolbar provides several formatting options, which are described in this section. If the picture toolbar does not appear when an image is selected, display it by selecting **View > Toolbars > Picture** from the menu bar.

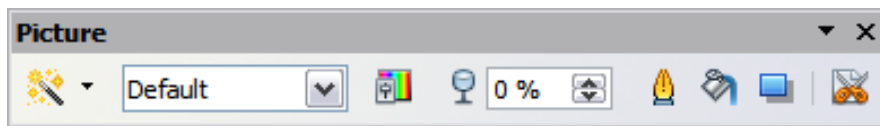


Figure 7: The Picture toolbar

Applying Filters

Use the  icon on the toolbar to apply various filters to the selected picture. The best way to judge if a filter works for your picture is to try it. To apply a filter:

- 1) Select the image so that the green handles around it are displayed.
- 2) Click on the  icon in the Picture toolbar. The toolbar will expand to show the icons in Figure 8.
- 3) Select the filter you wish to apply. To show the name of the filter, hover the mouse pointer over the icon and wait for the tooltip to appear.

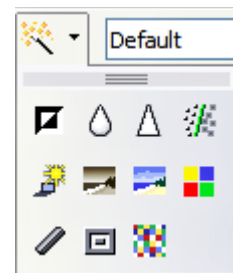


Figure 8: The graphic filters available in Impress

If you are not satisfied with the effect obtained or want to try a different one, before doing anything else, click the Undo button or select **Edit > Undo: Bitmap Graphic Filter** from the menu bar, or press *Control+Z*.

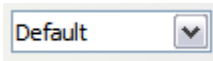
Table 1 describes briefly each of the available graphic filters and their effects. See the *Draw Guide* for examples of the effects.

Table 1: Graphic filters and their effects

Icon	Name	Effect
	Invert	Inverts the color values of a color image, or the brightness values of a grayscale image.
	Smooth	Softens the contrast of an image.
	Sharpen	Increases the contrast of an image.
	Remove noise	Removes single pixels from an image.
	Solarization	Mimics the effects of too much light in a picture. A further dialog opens to adjust the parameters.
	Aging	Simulates the effects of time on a picture. It can be applied several times. A further dialog will open to adjust the aging level.
	Posterize	Makes a picture appear like a painting by reducing the number of colors used.

Icon	Name	Effect
	Pop Art	Modifies the picture dramatically.
	Charcoal	Displays the image as a charcoal sketch.
	Relief	A dialog is displayed to adjust the light source, which in turn will create the shadow and hence the relief effect.
	Mosaic	Joins groups of pixels into a single area of one color.

Changing the Graphics Mode

Use the graphics mode drop-down list  in the Picture toolbar to change the mode of the image. Choose between:

- **Default:** No changes to the graphic object.
- **Grayscale:** The image is converted to scales of gray.
- **Black/White:** Each pixel of the image is converted to black or white depending on the brightness value.
- **Watermark:** adjusts the brightness of the image, making it suitable for use as a watermark. For more information on inserting watermarks in the presentation, refer to Chapter 2 (Slide Masters).

Adjusting the Color

Clicking the color adjustment button  on the Picture toolbar opens the color adjustment dialog, like that in Figure 9.

Use this dialog to modify the individual color components of the image (red, green, blue) as well as the brightness, contrast, and gamma of the image. If the result is not satisfactory, press *Control*+*Z* to restore the default values.

Increasing the gamma value of a picture makes it more suitable for use as a background or watermark; an image modified in this way will interfere less with dark text.

In the context of either image processing or image transmission, gamma refers to the clarity or cloudiness of an image. Under the hood, gamma involves the number of bits needed to encode an image, or the bandwidth needed to transport it. Too many bits, or too much bandwidth, can result in highlights indistinguishable to the human eye, while too few bits or too little bandwidth might produce unintended shadows.

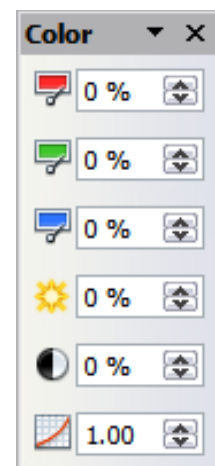


Figure 9: The color adjustment dialog

Setting the Object Transparency

Modify the percentage value in the Transparency box  0 % on the Picture toolbar to make the image more transparent. Note that this differs from the transparency settings for a line or a shape (described in Chapter 5). As with the

gamma value, increasing the transparency of a picture makes the picture blend more smoothly into the background, making overlay text easier to read.

Adjusting the Line, Area, and Shadow Settings

These settings are not very commonly used for images, except for the shadow setting, which applies a shadow to the image.

Cropping Pictures

Impress provides two ways to crop a picture: interactively or using a dialog. The interactive method is easier to use, but the dialog provides more precise control. You can use both methods: first, cropping interactively, then using the dialog to fine-tune the result.

To crop a selected picture interactively, click the Crop icon  on the Picture toolbar (Figure 7). A set of crop marks appears around the picture (see Figure 10).



Figure 10: Interactive crop marks

When you place the cursor over any of the crop marks, the cursor changes shape. Drag the mark to crop the picture. Click outside the picture to deactivate cropping mode.

Press the *Shift* button while working on the crop marks to produce the following effects:

- For a corner mark, the two sides of the picture forming the corner are cropped proportionally, with the picture anchored to the opposite corner mark.
- For a side mark, both dimensions are changed proportionally, with the image anchored to the opposite side mark.

The interactive crop mode operates in Keep Scale mode (see below).

To crop using the dialog, right-click a selected picture and choose **Crop Picture** (or choose **Format > Crop Picture** from the menu bar).

The Crop dialog (Figure 11) has the following options:

- **Keep scale / Keep image size** buttons: when *Keep scale* is selected (default), cropping the image does not alter the scale of the picture. When *Keep image size* is selected, cropping produces enlargement (for positive cropping values), shrinking (for negative cropping values), or distortion of the image so that the image size remains constant.

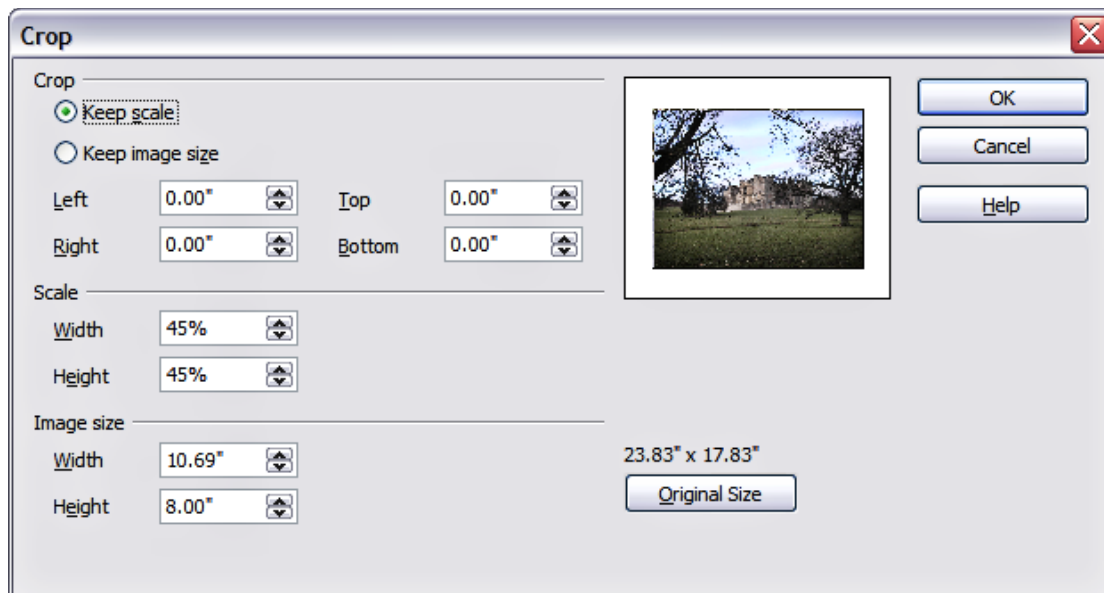


Figure 11: The options available when cropping a picture

- **Left, Right, Top, and Bottom:** The function of these boxes changes according to the choice made between *Keep scale* and *Keep image size*. In both cases, when a value is entered in one of these boxes, the image is cropped by that amount. For example, a value of 3cm in the Left box will cut 3cm from the left side of the picture.

When *Keep scale* is selected, the size of the image also changes, so in this example, the width will be reduced by 3 cm. If *Keep image size* is selected instead, the remaining part of the image is enlarged (positive values for cropping) or shrunk (negative values for cropping) so that the width and height of the image remain unchanged.

Note that the *Width* and *Height* fields change as you enter the values when in this mode. Use the thumbnail next to these fields to determine the correct amount by which to crop.

- **Scale Width and Height:** specify in percentages the scaling of the picture. The size of the image changes accordingly.
- **Image size:** specify the size of the image in your preferred unit of measurement. The image enlarges or shrinks accordingly.
- **Original size:** when clicked, restores the original image size.

Deleting a Picture

- 1) Click on the picture, if necessary, to show the green resizing handles.
- 2) Press *Delete*.

Creating an Image Map

An image map defines areas of an image (called *hotspots*) that are associated with a URL (a web address or a file on a computer). Hotspots are the graphic equivalent of text hyperlinks. Clicking on a hotspot causes Impress to open the linked page in the appropriate program (for example, the default browser for an HTML page, AOO Writer for an .ODT file, or a PDF viewer for a PDF file). You can create hotspots of various shapes and include several hotspots in the same image.

To use the image map tool:

- 1) Select the picture where hotspots will be defined.
- 2) Choose **Edit > ImageMap** from the menu bar. The ImageMap Editor dialog in Figure 12 opens. The main part of the dialog shows the image on which the hotspots will be defined. In this image, an active hotspot is indicated by a white shading, while an inactive hotspot is identified by a red border but no shading.
- 3) Use the tools and fields in the dialog to define the hotspots and links necessary.
- 4) Click the **Apply** icon  to apply the settings.
- 5) When done, click the **Save** icon  to save the imagemap to a file, then click the **X** in the upper-right corner to close the dialog.

The top part of the dialog contains the following tools:

- **Apply** button: Click this button to apply the changes.
- **Load, Save, and Select** icons.
- Tools for drawing a hotspot shape: these tools work in exactly the same way as the corresponding tools in the Drawing toolbar (described in Chapter 5).
- **Edit, Move, Insert, Delete Points**: advanced editing tools to manipulate the shape of a polygon hotspot. Select the Edit Points tool to activate the other tools.

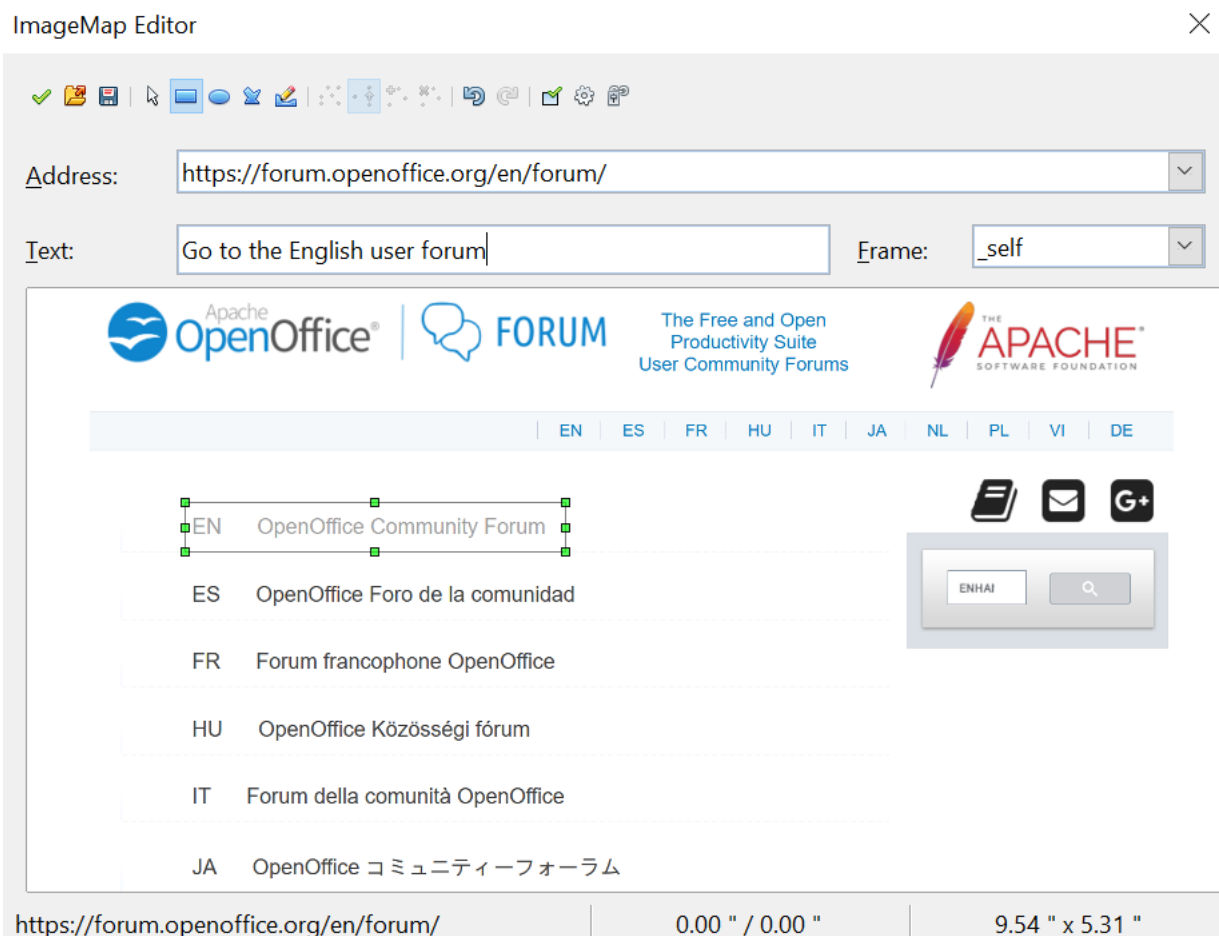


Figure 12: The dialog to create or edit an image map

- **Active** icon: toggles the status of the hotspot, activating a selected hotspot or deactivating it if it's active.
- **Macro**: associates a macro with the hotspot instead of a hyperlink.
- **Properties**: sets the hyperlink properties and adds the Name attribute to the hyperlink.

Below the toolbar, specify for the selected hotspot:

- **Address**: the address pointed to by the hyperlink. You can also point to an anchor in a document, such as a specific slide number; to do this, write the address in this format: `file:/// <path> /document_name#anchor_name`
- **Text**: enter the text that will be displayed when the mouse is moved over the hotspot.
- **Frame**: where the target of the hyperlink will open: pick among `_blank` (opens in a new browser window), `_self` (opens in the active browser window), `_top`, or `_parent`.

Tip

The value `_self` for the target frame will work just fine in the vast majority of contexts. It is therefore not recommended to use the other values unless absolutely necessary.
